

Michael Gikaru

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SUMMARY

Solutions-focused Software Engineer with experience designing, building, and supporting web, mobile, and backend systems across startups, consulting environments, and distributed teams. Skilled at translating business requirements into practical technical solutions, system designs, prototypes, and implementation plans.

Experience spans software architecture, API integration, cloud platforms, CI/CD, distributed systems, databases, mobile development, and technical assessments. Comfortable working independently, investigating complex technical problems, communicating with both technical and non-technical stakeholders, and supporting systems throughout the software development lifecycle.

Strong interest in AI-powered solutions, automation, developer tooling, and system design. Recognized for analytical thinking, technical communication, and the ability to rapidly learn and apply new technologies to solve business challenges.

EDUCATION

Kenyatta University

Bachelor of Arts, Psychology Major | Economics Minor

Nyeri High School

Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education (KCSE), Grade: B+

EXPERIENCE

Software Assessment Evaluator

Oct 2020 – Present

Woven

Evaluate technical capabilities of software engineers across frontend, backend, cloud, and systems engineering disciplines.

- Assessed engineering solutions across React, Angular, Vue, JavaScript, and TypeScript ecosystems.
- Evaluated system architecture designs involving AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud Platform environments.
- Reviewed SQL implementations, database design decisions, and data access strategies.
- Assessed technical communication, troubleshooting approaches, and customer support problem-solving capabilities.
- Evaluated software design decisions, user stories, requirements interpretation, and product development workflows.
- Produced structured technical feedback and recommendations to support engineering growth and hiring decisions.
- Identified architectural strengths, risks, and improvement opportunities within candidate solutions.

Scala Developer / Full Stack Engineer

May 2021 – Jul 2021

Recordbay GmbH

Contributed to backend and frontend systems while supporting automation and operational workflows.

- Developed React components for customer-facing applications.
- Built server-side functionality using Scala, Play Framework, and Akka.
- Automated operational processes through Bash scripting.
- Improved internal workflows by reducing manual effort through automation.
- Collaborated within a distributed engineering environment.

Software Engineer

Apr 2020 – Jul 2020

Adalabs

Developed mobile and backend solutions for a social networking platform.

- Built Android application features using modern architecture patterns.
- Integrated OAuth authentication with Google, LinkedIn, Facebook, and Twitter.
- Implemented real-time communication using Socket.IO.
- Supported backend architecture discussions and graph database modeling.
- Improved deployment workflows using Jenkins and Slack-based automation.
- Collaborated with stakeholders and development teams to deliver platform functionality.

Software Developer

Mar 2020 – Apr 2020

Kamusi Project International

Supported backend systems, data migration initiatives, and integration projects.

- Maintained Node.js and Nginx infrastructure.
- Designed and implemented ETL processes between MongoDB and Neo4j.
- Improved data accessibility through graph database integration.
- Supported backend services and operational troubleshooting.

Backend & Android Developer

Sep 2019 – Jan 2020

Uchat Inc

Worked on backend services, Android applications, build automation, and communication technologies.

- Developed CI/CD pipelines using CircleCI.
- Built backend services and Android application functionality.
- Created build tooling supporting multi-language environments.
- Implemented WebRTC-based communication solutions.
- Developed automation scripts and deployment tooling.
- Contributed to architecture and system design discussions.

Software Developer

May 2019 – Aug 2019

EdgeTech Consultants Limited

Led development activities for the Mjirani mobile application.

- Designed architecture for an offline-first Android application.
- Implemented synchronization strategies for distributed mobile data.
- Developed recommendation engine prototypes using graph technologies.
- Built backend API integrations supporting mobile functionality.
- Produced technical recommendations and implementation guidance.
- Researched and evaluated technologies to support long-term scalability.

Web Developer

Sep 2014 – Dec 2014

Daktari Media Services Limited

Worked on web solution prototyping and technical consultation.

- Developed solution prototypes using Drupal.
- Evaluated implementation approaches and platform capabilities.
- Recommended modules and architecture approaches for project requirements.
- Produced reports and implementation recommendations.
- Worked directly with stakeholders to understand business needs.

Web Design Tutor

Jan 2015 – Apr 2015

Kivuli College

- Delivered training in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and PHP.
- Developed instructional material and practical exercises.
- Supported learners through hands-on technical projects.

CMS Tutor

Apr 2014 – Aug 2014

Kivuli College

- Delivered training on Drupal, Joomla, and WordPress.

- Helped learners understand content management workflows and website administration.

PROJECTS

Twaa Social Network | Mobile-first social networking platform focused on mentorship and community engagement.

- Developed Android frontend architecture.
- Integrated OAuth authentication providers.
- Implemented real-time messaging capabilities.
- Collaborated with backend teams on platform design.
- Participated in technical planning and solution implementation.

Mjirani | Offline-capable Android platform designed for community-focused engagement.

- Designed mobile architecture.
- Implemented synchronization strategies.
- Developed recommendation engine concepts using graph technologies.
- Evaluated scalability and future architectural improvements.

Uchat Communicator | Cross-platform communication application.

- Contributed to Android development.
- Built backend functionality.
- Implemented WebRTC communication features.
- Developed CI/CD and build automation workflows.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Solution Engineering

Requirements Analysis

Functional Specifications

Technical Documentation

System Design

Software Architecture

Proof of Concept Development

Technical Discovery

REST APIs

Service Oriented Architecture

System Integration

Authentication & Authorization

OAuth

API Design

Event Driven Systems

Distributed Systems

Microservices Concepts

SQL

PostgreSQL

Neo4j

MongoDB

Graph Databases

ETL Processes

Data Modeling

Cloud Platforms

CI/CD

Jenkins

CircleCI
Docker
Linux
Git
SDLC
Troubleshooting & Incident Resolution
AI Tool Evaluation
LLM Integrations
Workflow Automation
Process Optimization
Technical Research
Developer Productivity Solutions
JavaScript
TypeScript
Kotlin
Scala
PHP
Bash
Haskell
React
Angular
HTML5
CSS3
Redux
RxJS
Node.js
Akka HTTP
Play Framework
Http4s
Finagle
Android (Kotlin)
Android Architecture Components
MvRx
Room
AWS
Google Cloud Platform
DigitalOcean
Supabase
Vercel
GitHub Actions
Elasticsearch
OrientDB
WebRTC
Socket.IO
ZeroMQ
JSON
YAML
XML

ERD
UML
Workflow Modeling
Technical Diagrams

TECHNICAL WRITING & KNOWLEDGE SHARING

Published technical articles covering: Kotlin Development; State Machines; Reactive Programming; ZeroMQ; Distributed Systems Concepts; Android Development. Medium Profile: medium.com/@thealmikey

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION - WORKING STYLE

Independent and self-directed; Strong analytical and problem-solving skills; Comfortable working with distributed teams; Experienced in remote collaboration; Strong written and verbal communication

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION - PROFESSIONAL INTERESTS

AI and Automation; System Architecture; Developer Productivity; Distributed Systems; Cloud Technologies; Knowledge Sharing

KEYWORDS FOR ATS ALIGNMENT

Solutions Engineering • Technical Documentation • Requirements Analysis • System Design • REST APIs • SQL • JSON • YAML • XML • CI/CD • Cloud Platforms • Service Oriented Architecture • Distributed Systems • Microservices • Authentication • OAuth • Integration Architecture • Technical Specifications • Incident Resolution • Software Development Lifecycle • AI Tools • Automation • PaaS Platforms • Enterprise Integration • API Design • Stakeholder Communication